

SENATE BILL 2073

By Watson

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15,
Chapter 2, relative to native plant month.

WHEREAS, the cultivation, growth, and sale of native plants support Tennessee's robust agriculture and nursery industries, creating jobs in horticulture, landscaping, and ecotourism while also increasing property values; and

WHEREAS, native plants, indigenous species that have evolved alongside native wildlife and occur naturally across the State of Tennessee and in specific geographic regions, ecosystems, and habitats, are essential for maintaining healthy, diverse, and sustainable ecosystems; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee is home to over 2,400 native plant species, including large shade trees, shrubs, perennials, vines, grasses, and wildflowers; and

WHEREAS, native plants are well-adapted to Tennessee's soils, temperatures, precipitation, and environmental conditions, making them the ideal choice for conserving and protecting our Tennessee environment and adapting to its changes and playing a crucial role in cleaning the air, filtering water, and stabilizing soils; and

WHEREAS, it is a policy of this State to encourage public awareness about the benefits of Tennessee's native plants to pollinators and other wildlife, to the economy, and the health and sustainability of Tennessee's ecosystem; now, therefore,

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15, Chapter 2, is amended by adding the following new section:

The month of April of each year is hereby designated as "Tennessee Native Plant Month" in this state.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.